

03/08/2026

Organizational Psychology

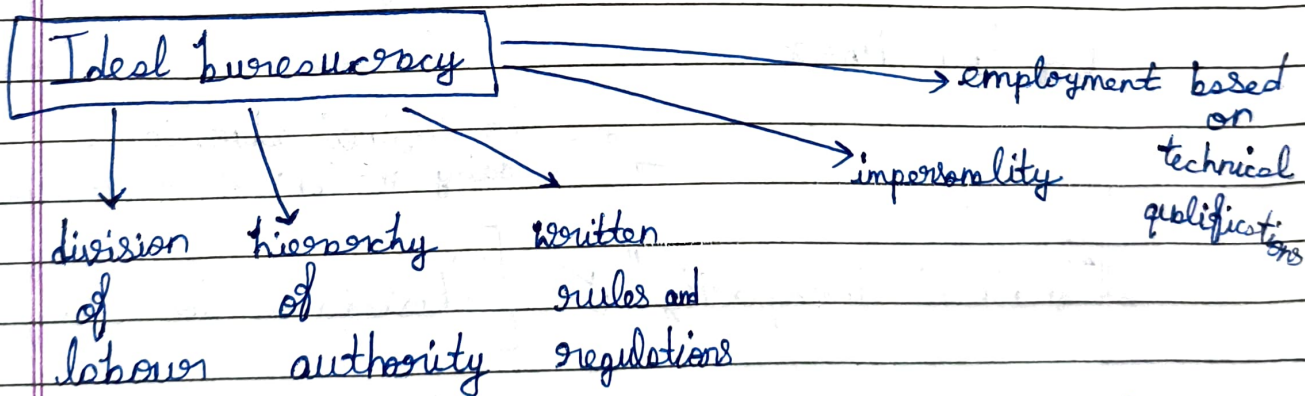
Organization: A consciously coordinated social unit of two or more people that functions on a relatively continuous basis to achieve a common goal.

(Organizational Behavior)
by Dr. Robbins
Textbook

(*) Domain of Org. Psy. → Understanding the psychology of the workers

What is the domain of OP?

Bureaucracy: A component of formal organization that uses rules and hierarchical ranking to achieve efficiency.



मूलतः यह सिद्धांत किसी भी bureaucracy में होना चाहिए

(to be used as a baseline standard)

(*) "Ideal type - A" → characterized by the aforementioned principles
Prof. Max Weber

Its domain centers on employee well-being, ←
optimizing group dynamics and enhancing overall
organizational effectiveness

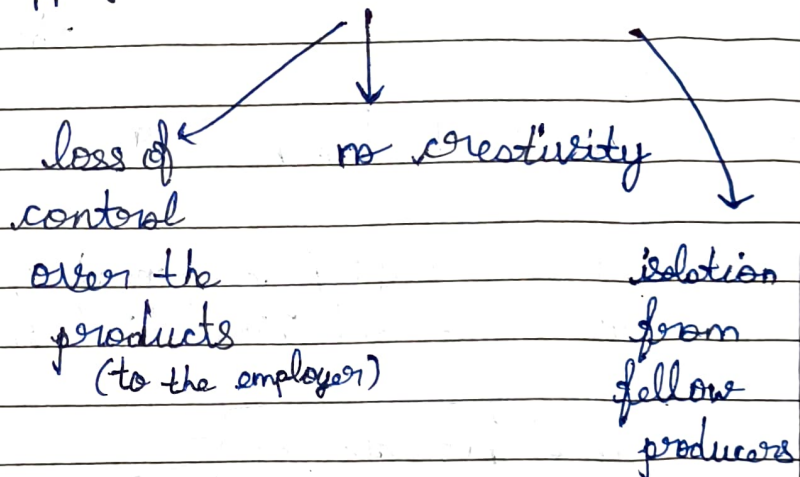
Hierarchy of Authority:

Needed for smooth workflow, accountability, enhanced efficiency and control over workflow.

Division of Labor:-

"Bureaucracy is the child of Capitalism"

Sir Charlie Chaplin clipping → Alienation conditions



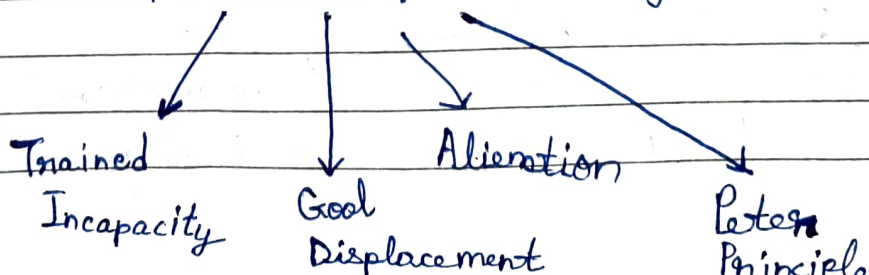
Prof. Karl Marx

due to trained adaptation to doing mechanical work consistently

"Trained incapacity" ✓ { (Resistance to Change)

"Bureaucracy have remarkable stability; they are reluctant to adapt to change" ✓

Criticisms/Drawbacks of Bureaucracy



Written Rules and Regulations

Bureaucracies are substantially rule-driven

Overemphasis on rules can lead to goal displacement.

over-zealous conformity

Impersonality

Bureaucratic officials perform their duties without giving personal consideration to people as individuals

No personal empathy

Employment based on Technical Qualifications:-

"Peter Principle"

→ every employee within a hierarchy tends to rise to his/her level of incompetence.

Promotion based on performance at the previous level.

Division of labour → specialization in one particular task/job

Eg. - A 20,000+ citation all Fellow Professor may not be a good Vice Chancellor/Director or a Good Teacher

"carrot and stick" approach

Scientific Management Approach

Proposed by Prof. F. W. Taylor

analysis by

The scientific management of all tasks which need to be done for maximum efficiency.

There is only one way to motivate the workers (incentives / money).

They need to be monitored / supervised.

Maintain a distance with the workers.

"minimum-interaction model"

We consider workers as indolent (Drawback)

"Take it easy approach"

Designing jobs such that maximum technical division of labour is achieved.

Giving them deadlines, hard tasks, etc.

Major Criticism of SMA:-

- Trust Factor is not there.
- Hostile attitude towards workers which may cause net productivity to suffer
- No emotional support towards the workers

Prof. Karl Marx Book Notes

In the Paris Manuscripts (1844):

- i. Loss of control of the products made by workers (to employer)
- ii. Relationships between fellow workers ^{as} not as colleagues, but as rivals, for pay, bonus, promotion and relationships between employer and workers as that of master and slave.
- iii. The motivating force to do job is merely the payment received for one's labour (extrinsic factor) and not the intrinsic true satisfaction of one's work.
- iv. Denied the true essence of human nature - self-expression through work (work not feels as a sense of pride and achievement). cog in the wheel

Sir

As per Friedrich Engels:

"Being constrained to do work against one's true will is terrible."

People feel isolated and frustrated from the work environment and hence resort to drinking, smoking, consumerism, depression, or a privatised lifestyle, to release their internal burden.

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Parkinson's Law

Bureaucracies have a tendency to expand over the years.

"Procrastination" (tendency to delay the operations)

↳ More intake of job freshers will lead to delay in operations

Tendency to procrastinate

More and more people may not necessarily lead to efficiency in an organization.

Fordism

Sir Henry Ford, Ford Motors Founder.

The worker was reduced to a machine and he could not use his discretion while at work and he had to simply follow orders.

Follow SMA.

Compensated workers with high wages.

SMA ⇒ "Carrot and stick" approach

either reward good workers
OR punish underperforming workers

(opposite of SMA)

Human Relations Approach

- Was proposed by Prof. Elton Mayo
- Worker's behaviour can be attributed to their 'son-timents' rather than to their 'reason'.
- An emphasis on the notion of system and organic analogy.
- Workers can raise their voice / say to the organization.
- Workers are not only governed by the organizational rules; they have their personal set of rules also.
(informal norms also)

"Chiselers vs. Ratebusters"

Case Study: "Thanks For Nothing"

Employee recognition schemes

Empty gesture rather than motivation

Simple appreciation tokens are better than expensive rewards.

Badges were given randomly

Company had strict dress code (so no sense of rewarding T-shirts)

CASE STUDY

Tip for Exam: First read the questions, then the case study!!

→ Praise must be given in compliance with the specific accomplishment.

a 1.). Companies and managers do not often praise their employees because the inappropriate provision of appreciation to increase works and/or overappreciation of someone's work may lead to unbecome, undesired undesirable values, in the employees. Unjustified praise might lead to complacency in the praised employee, alongside arises dissatisfaction among unpraised workers. Lack of justified praise will lead to also harmful impacts, distilling a sense of meaninglessness, job dissatisfaction and job-transient attitude among the employees.

a 2.). To motivate employees as a manager, verbal appreciation at mild level along with some tangible rewards such as bonuses / best employee award / memento after careful evaluation of his/her performance in some measurable parameters would be some of the suitable approaches that I would adopt to maintain discipline, but not at the cost of employee dissatisfaction.

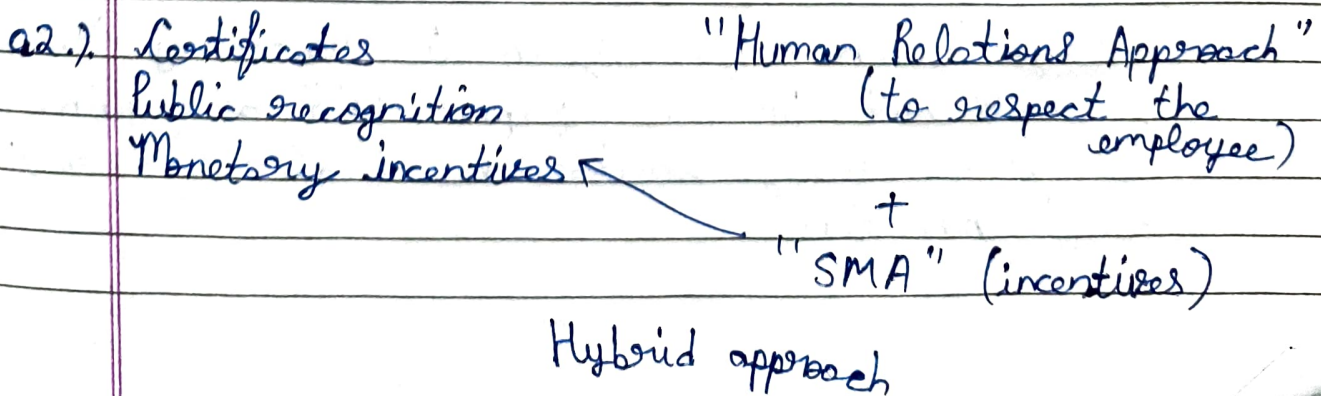
a 3.). Giving too much verbal praise to employees is a risky approach if not managed properly, because this might lead to elevated attitude

of complacency and arrogance, and might lead to dissatisfaction among other employees that their efforts are not worth the praise received by that particular person.

- a4. As a manager, I would need to adopt four or five possible approaches to justifiably appreciate some employee's accomplishments. Regular/Scenario-specific praise of an employee in a non-repetitive manner, along with, comprehensive employee assessment-based reward strategies, with some tangible, apparent tokens of appreciation, including bonuses, promotions (at sub-levels), mementos, etc. may be a valuable approach that intermittently gives motivational boost to the employees, since I would do it in a transparent, employee-agnostic approach after consulting all employees in a positive manner.

Sign's Insights:

- a1.) Employee Complacency
 ✓ Time-constraints for the company
 ✓ Scientific Management Approach (incentives can only be a "praise"; "Minimum interaction model"; workers are generally indolent (so don't praise))



- a3.) Value of the verbal praise will decline.
Employee complacency
Employee jealousy

"Fixing the Yandstick"

↙
Proportional reward to a particular achievement

- a4.) Self-Inside Self-Outside
Others-Inside Others-Outside } → ^{fair comparison}
generally made by employees
Competitive rewards as per markets

Unbiased reward system
Anonymous feedback collection

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"Organic Analogy" in Human Relations Approach

↓
Comparing the functioning of organization with the functioning of the human body, with the hierarchy of various organ systems.

Every human organ system is necessary. Even a small cut in the finger will also pain. Similarly, every worker must also be considered important.

"Hawthorne Effect" (Hawthorne, Chicago, USA)

Productivity was good in both the rooms even under light fluctuations and darkness (This is because the workers were felt respected and appreciated).

"Bank Wiring Observation Room" (BWOR)

6,000 units of work → fair daily work

The employees expected the underperforming workers to match up to the "ratebusters" (overperforming) workers and were verbally abused as "chisellers".

The most admired worker was the one who showed maximum resentment to the organization.

The BWOR experiment highlights a critical gap not considered in SMA:—

✓ ✓ ["Informal norms about workers groups are to be equally considered"]

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Depends on:

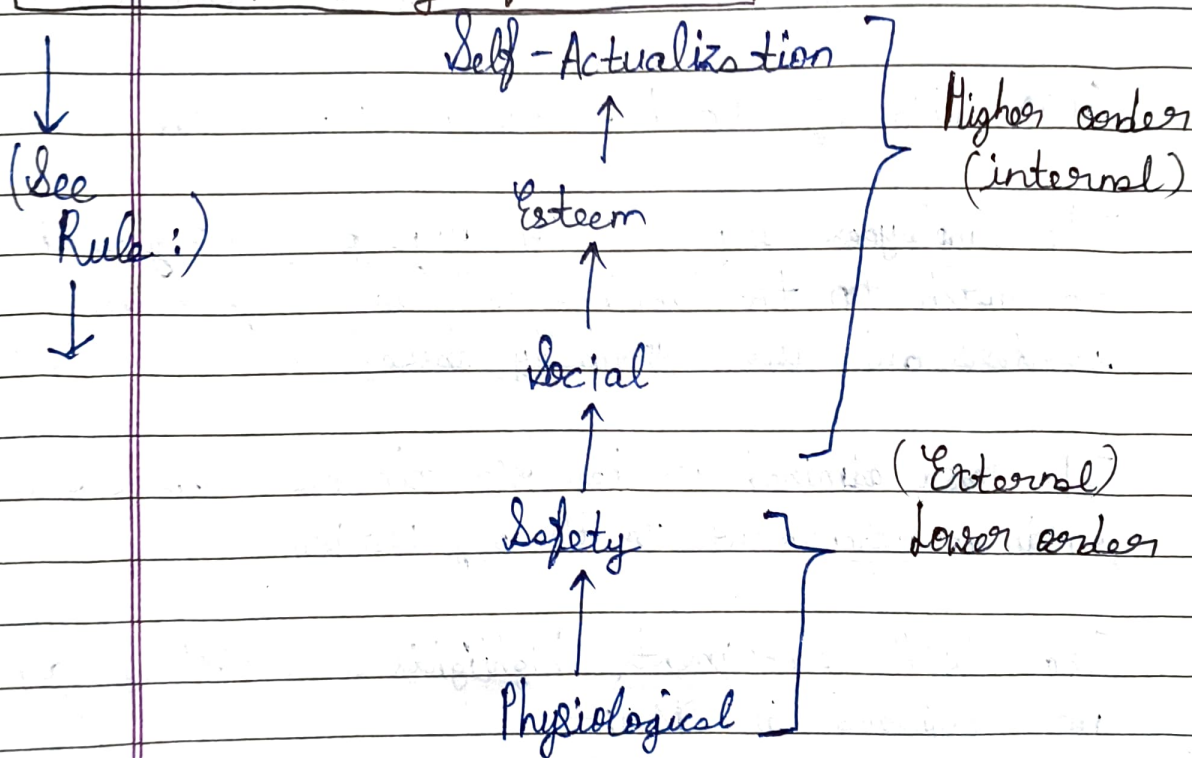
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Motivation: -

- Intensity
- Direction
- Persistence

The processes that account for an individual's intensity, direction, and persistence of effort toward attaining a goal (specifically, the organizational goal).

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs: -



Self-Actualization } Where are you able to realize your fullest potential?

Rule: - As each need is substantially satisfied, the next need becomes dominant motivating factor.

Criticism of Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs;

A poor man does not necessarily become attracted to money alone; their ethical needs (Esteem) may be more than essential than money (for physiological needs).

Many rich people engage in corrupt practices (for their undue physiological needs) rather than banking for higher, esteem or self-actualization needs. ("White collar crime").

Human desires are limitless (Maslow's Theory is not taking into account).

McGregor's Theory X and Y :-

Theory X	Theory Y
Workers have little ambition / ambition	Workers are self-directed
They dislike work	They enjoy work
Avoid responsibility	Accept responsibility

(SMA is more closer)

(HRA is more closer)



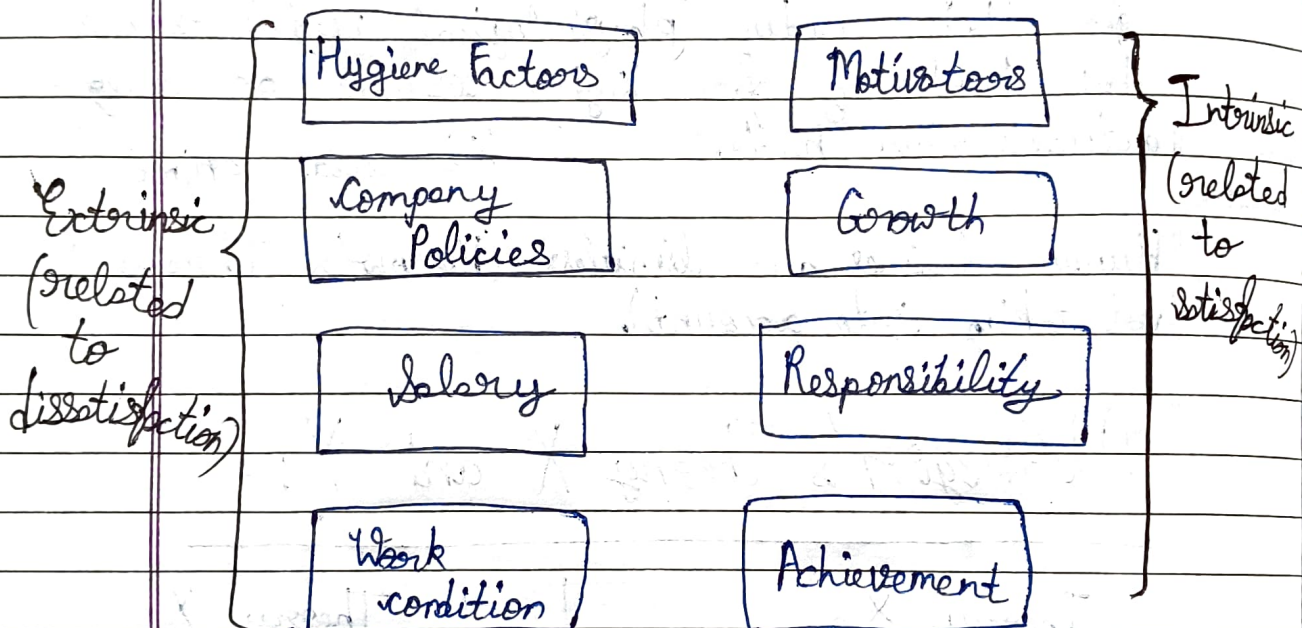
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Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory

The opposite of satisfaction is no satisfaction.

The opposite of dissatisfaction is no dissatisfaction.



इन्हें पूरा करने से
dissatisfaction दूर होगा,
पर satisfaction नहीं प्राप्त
होगा

Dissatisfaction वाली column में जो factors
that are not essentially motivating in nature
as per Herzberg (but these are approxi-
mately corresponding to the external (lower
order needs) as per Maslow's Theory.

Herzberg's theory has limited applicability than Maslow's theory (since limited to only particular conditions of the workers).

Example: -

(Many PhD and B.Tech. people are unemployed / underemployed)

McClelland's Three Needs Theory :-

- i. Need for Achievement (nAch)
- ii. Need for Power (nPow)
- iii. Need for Affiliation (nAff)

- Achievement drive is typically more prominent if the success rate is nearly 50% because they will not feel any motivation if success rate is 10% (due to sheer luck) and 90% (due to no risk).
- Need for Power (nPow) and need for ^{affiliation} achievement (nAff) are the most essential parameters that shape how a leader is becoming. (not achievement!!)
- The goal should be clear (specific)
- The goal should be considerably difficult (not impossible).

Bandura's Self-Efficacy Theory:

How to enhance self-efficacy? Practice #

An individual's belief that he or she is capable of performing a task.

Getting inspiration from others.

"Pegmation Effect": - When you praise your employees, you are motivating them for enhancing their efficiency.

"Gabotes Effect": - Self-confidence leads to better performance (due to good self-encouragement).

"Golem Effect": - When we say that an employee cannot do it (criticize the employee), the performance gets debilitated to low.

Ques. Explain how Goal-Setting Theory is complemented by Self-Efficacy Theory?

Adam's Equity Theory:-

Self - Inside

Others - Inside

Self - Outside

Others - Outside

- * First theory that considers "what workers think actually" instead of "what manager should do".

Venem's Expectancy Theory:-

The strength of a tendency to act in a certain way depends on the strength of an expectation that the act will be followed by a given outcome, and on the attractiveness of the outcome to the individual.

यह theory भी worker's perspective की देखनी है।